

FOC WATCHES. YOU COMMAND.

- PREVENT NEEDLESS LOSSES**
Detects damaged ships at risk and recommends immediate withdrawal to safety—before it's too late.
- RECOVER WITH CONFIDENCE**
Confirms docking and repair status, tracks recovery progress, and preserves commanders and assignments.
- RETURN TO DUTY**
Returns ships only when they are truly ready—restored, reassigned, and ready to fight.
- FLEET READINESS CLARITY**
See exact readiness across hull, shields, ammo, drones, crew, and captains—no guesswork, no false green.
- EVIDENCE YOU CAN TRUST**
Every recommendation and action is logged with proof—what, why, when, and verified results.

PLAYER FIRST. ALWAYS.
Advisory by default. Approval required. You decide. FOC executes with precision and respect.

FOC does not replace your command.
It protects your fleet so you can command tomorrow.

BUILT FOR X4: FOUNDATIONS
BY **RazorEQX**
WITH SCOUT AI DEVELOPMENT PARTNER
UPB SHIP TRACKING COLLABORATOR

FLEET OPERATIONS COMMAND

Complete Player Guide

v1.34 | Build 035 | X4: Foundations

PROTECT. RECOVER. RESTORE. RETURN.

FOC watches. You command.

Applies to: Fleet Operations Command v1.34, Build 035

Game: X4: Foundations

Purpose: Help a new player find fleets, start patrols, answer distress calls, train Pilots and Marines, maintain damaged or lost ships, and understand every FOC page without guessing.

FOC is designed to be safe. It explains what it found, what it plans to do, and why an action was allowed or blocked. You stay in command.

Some screenshots were captured during development and may show Build 033 or Build 034 in the title bar. Build 035 keeps the illustrated controls. The text and button names in this guide describe the accepted v1.34 release.

1. What FOC does

Fleet Operations Command is a fleet patrol, readiness, recovery, training, and response console. It helps answer seven questions:

- 1 Which player combat fleets exist right now?
- 2 Which fleets are ready to receive orders?
- 3 Which ships need captains?
- 4 Where should each fleet use as Home?
- 5 Which distress calls should a fleet answer?
- 6 Which damaged or lost fleet ships need attention?
- 7 Did X4 actually accept the requested action?

FOC uses X4's live commander hierarchy instead of trusting fleet names or old markers. It can start native patrols, help staff ships, hand damaged ships to X4's native Repair / Upgrade screen, preserve exact lost-ship records, request guarded rebuilds, and send one eligible response fleet to a fresh attack.

What FOC does not do silently

- It does not take control from the player.
- It does not replace an existing captain without approval.
- It does not control the ship you are personally flying.
- It does not move cargo or buy ship blueprints.
- It does not create free repairs or free replacement ships.
- It does not spend Academy or rebuild resources without a visible player-approved action.
- It does not change X4's story or mission state.
- It does not treat missing information as safe.

Four words you should know

- **UNKNOWN** means FOC could not prove the information. It does not mean everything is fine.
- **BLOCKED** means a safety check stopped the action. Nothing changed.

- **PENDING** means FOC sent a request and is waiting for X4 to report back.
- **ACTIVE / CONFIRMED** means X4 returned the expected order or state.

Simple rule: If you are unsure, stop clicking and read the orange, red, or green result line. Then open ACTIVITY.

2. Install, update, or remove FOC

Steam Workshop

- 1 Subscribe to [Fleet Operations Command on Steam](#).
- 2 Let Steam finish downloading it.
- 3 Start X4.
- 4 Open **Extensions** and make sure Fleet Operations Command is enabled.

Manual installation

- 1 Close X4 normally.
- 2 Extract the `jk_foc` folder into the X4 extensions folder.
- 3 Check that the final path ends like this:

```
X4 Foundations/extensions/jk_foc/content.xml
```

Do not place `jk_foc` inside a second `jk_foc` folder. Do not mix files from different versions.

Updating

Steam updates the Workshop copy automatically. For a manual copy, close X4, preserve the previous folder if you want a rollback copy, and replace the complete `jk_foc` folder.

Version 1.34 migrates valid FOC plans, recovery records, Academy state, and exact story-ship answers from existing saves. Missing or malformed records remain blocked instead of being guessed.

Removing

Close X4, unsubscribe on Steam or remove the manual `jk_foc` folder, then start X4 again. FOC does not add custom ships, sectors, stations, or wares required for a save to load.

3. Open FOC and learn the screen

- 1 Load your save.
- 2 Dock at a station or ship.
- 3 Open the normal docked interaction menu.
- 4 Select **OPEN FLEET OPERATIONS COMMAND**.
- 5 Wait for the bounded inventory snapshot to finish.

The top bar has eight tabs:

- 1 **COMMAND** - fleet status, global authority, plan controls, and emergency stop.
- 2 **FLEETS** - fleet selection, Home, patrol, distress rules, story protection, and maintenance.
- 3 **READINESS** - captain coverage, proven vacancies, and unknown evidence.
- 4 **TRAINING ACADEMY** - Pilot and Marine trainees, seminars, assignments, and captain auto-fill.
- 5 **ACADEMY STORE** - approved training-supply purchases and inventory results.
- 6 **FLEET RESPONSE** - current incidents and eligible dispatch.
- 7 **ACTIVITY** - requests, blockers, native readback, and recent history.
- 8 **SETTINGS** - persistent authority and safety behavior.

Use **REFRESH** when you want a new bounded snapshot. A refresh does not send orders.

Color language

- **Blue/cyan:** navigation, selection, or an editable control.
- **Green:** verified, accepted, ready, or active.
- **Orange/amber:** warning, preview, approval, or action needed.
- **Red:** a proven failure, damage event, or missing safety requirement.
- **Gray:** neutral information or an unavailable control.

4. Your first 10 minutes

Use this safe setup the first time:

- 1 Open **SETTINGS**.
- 2 Keep **Master mode** on **PREVIEW PLAN**.
- 3 Press **REFRESH** once.
- 4 Open **COMMAND** and confirm the fleet count looks reasonable.
- 5 Open **READINESS** and check for ships marked **MISSING**.
- 6 Open **FLEETS** and select one normal player combat fleet.
- 7 Choose a Home point.
- 8 Set distress-response options.
- 9 Read the summary: Home, Fleet Order, Distress Call, and Return.
- 10 Press **SEND THIS FLEET ON PATROL - REPLACES CURRENT ORDERS**.
- 11 Wait for **PATROL ACTIVE - DISTRESS RESPONSE ARMED**.
- 12 Open **ACTIVITY** and read the returned result.

You do not need global Apply to start one fleet. The main button on **FLEETS** handles only the selected fleet.

5. COMMAND - understand the whole force



Command page

What this page does

Command shows the number of known fleet commanders, proven problems, the active authority mode, the latest result, and global plan controls.

The three authority modes

- **PREVIEW PLAN** - safest mode. FOC can explain plans but does not run the global Apply action.
- **APPLY APPROVED PLAN** - allows the player to approve eligible saved and unlocked fleet orders from Command.
- **FULL AUTOMATION** - allows the bounded scheduler to send one eligible distress response per cycle.

Changing the mode does not apply a plan by itself.

Global Apply

- 1 Select **PREVIEW CURRENT PLAN**.
- 2 Read the counts and blockers.
- 3 Choose **APPLY APPROVED PLAN**.
- 4 Select **APPLY APPROVED PLAN - SEND ORDERS**.
- 5 Wait for readback.
- 6 Open **ACTIVITY** and check every active, blocked, inactive, and locked-skipped result.

For normal play, use the selected-fleet button on **FLEETS**. It is easier to understand and affects a smaller scope.

Emergency stop

Select **STOP FOC AUTOMATION** to return to Preview Plan and stop background response dispatch. It does not erase saved fleet settings or cancel unrelated X4 orders.

6. FLEETS - find, configure, and send one fleet



Fleets page

Why the fleet list changed in v1.34

FOC now discovers player-owned top-level combat commanders and their living ship subordinates from X4's actual hierarchy. A fleet name, Reaction Force label, or old saved marker does not create membership.

Station guards, station-commanded ships, non-combat commanders, and cargo or mining fleets are excluded from the normal combat list. Use the page arrows when more fleets exist than fit on one page.

Step 1 - Choose a fleet

- 1 Pick a fleet from the list on the left.
- 2 Make sure the row says **SELECTED**.
- 3 Check the flagship, location, captain, hull, shields, and visible members.
- 4 Read any red or orange protection message before changing an order.

Step 2 - Answer a story-ship question carefully

If X4 still marks one ship as protected, FOC asks:

Is this ship still being used by a story or mission?

- Choose **YES - KEEP IT PROTECTED** while the ship is still needed by a story or mission.
- Choose **NO - LET FOC CONTROL IT** only after that story or mission is finished.

The answer applies only to the named ship and is saved with its stable ship ID. It changes FOC's protection only. It never changes X4's story, mission, rewards, or completion state.

After you answer, the question and both buttons disappear. FOC automatically releases the exact player-owned Yaki cover ship only when X4 positively reports that its owning story is complete. Unknown ships stay protected.

Step 3 - Choose Home

- 1 Select **CHOOSE HOME POINT ON MAP**.
- 2 Move the map to a discovered sector.
- 3 Right-click the exact spot the fleet should use as Home.
- 4 Select **SET AS FOC HOME POINT**.
- 5 Return to FOC and confirm the sector and coordinates.

Choosing Home sends no order.

Step 4 - Set the fleet order and distress rules

Choose:

- the native fleet order: **Patrol** or **Guard Home**;
- distress-response range;
- whether to help player ships;
- whether to help player stations;
- minimum urgency from 1 to 10;
- ship hull threshold;
- station hull threshold; and
- whether to resume the fleet's native default order afterward.

Urgency 1 is light damage. Urgency 10 is critical damage. Response range limits which distress calls are eligible; it does not create a custom patrol route.

Step 5 - Send the fleet

Read the summary, then select:

SEND THIS FLEET ON PATROL - REPLACES CURRENT ORDERS

This action saves the selected fleet, unlocks only that fleet, replaces only eligible current orders, starts its native default order, and arms its distress response.

FOC reports **PATROL ACTIVE** only after X4 returns the intended current and default order. Player control, missing captain, missing Home, current story protection, non-combat scope, or a critical non-cancelable order still blocks the send.

7. Repair, replace, or rebuild fleet ships

Open **FLEETS**, then choose **REPAIR / REPLACE / REBUILD**.

Repair a living damaged ship

- 1 Refresh the page.
- 2 Select an eligible damaged fleet member.
- 3 Read the ownership, fleet, story, player-control, and order checks.
- 4 Open X4's native Repair / Upgrade screen.
- 5 Review X4's real price and resources.
- 6 Confirm or cancel in X4.

FOC does not create a free repair and does not press X4's confirmation for you.

Review a lost ship

FOC preserves exact recovery records for enrolled fleets. A usable record includes the ship macro, saved loadout, original commander relationship, subordinate group, and protection state.

Before a rebuild can be offered, FOC checks:

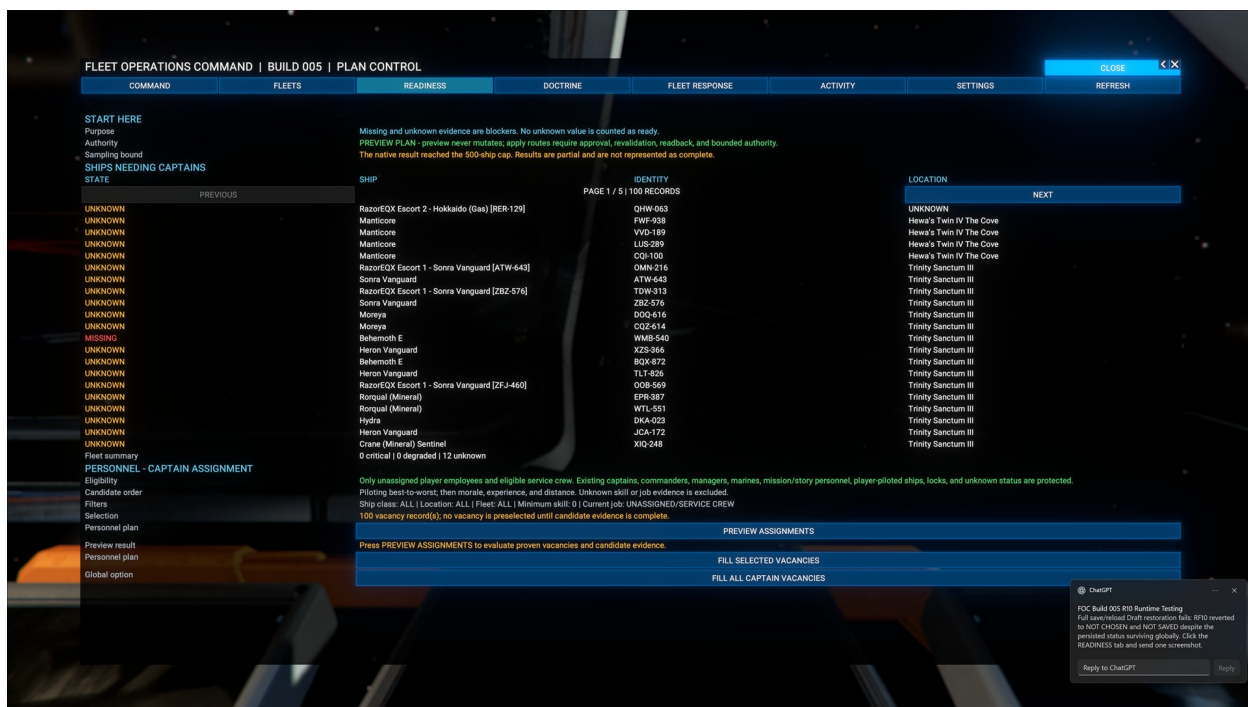
- the ship is positively lost and has no living duplicate;
- the exact ship blueprint is owned;
- a compatible player-owned yard can build the hull;
- the yard can provide the saved loadout;
- no duplicate build already exists; and
- mission/story and authority checks still pass.

Request replacement or rebuilding

Preview first. Confirmation sends only exact eligible records to X4. Normal player-yard resources are consumed. FOC does not buy missing blueprints, use an NPC yard, guess a replacement design, or claim completion while a ship is merely queued.

When X4 reports native build completion, FOC restores the saved ship name and hierarchy where the commander relationship can be proven. A rebuilt ship may still need a captain.

8. READINESS - find ships without captains



Readiness page

Readiness separates proven captain vacancies from incomplete evidence.

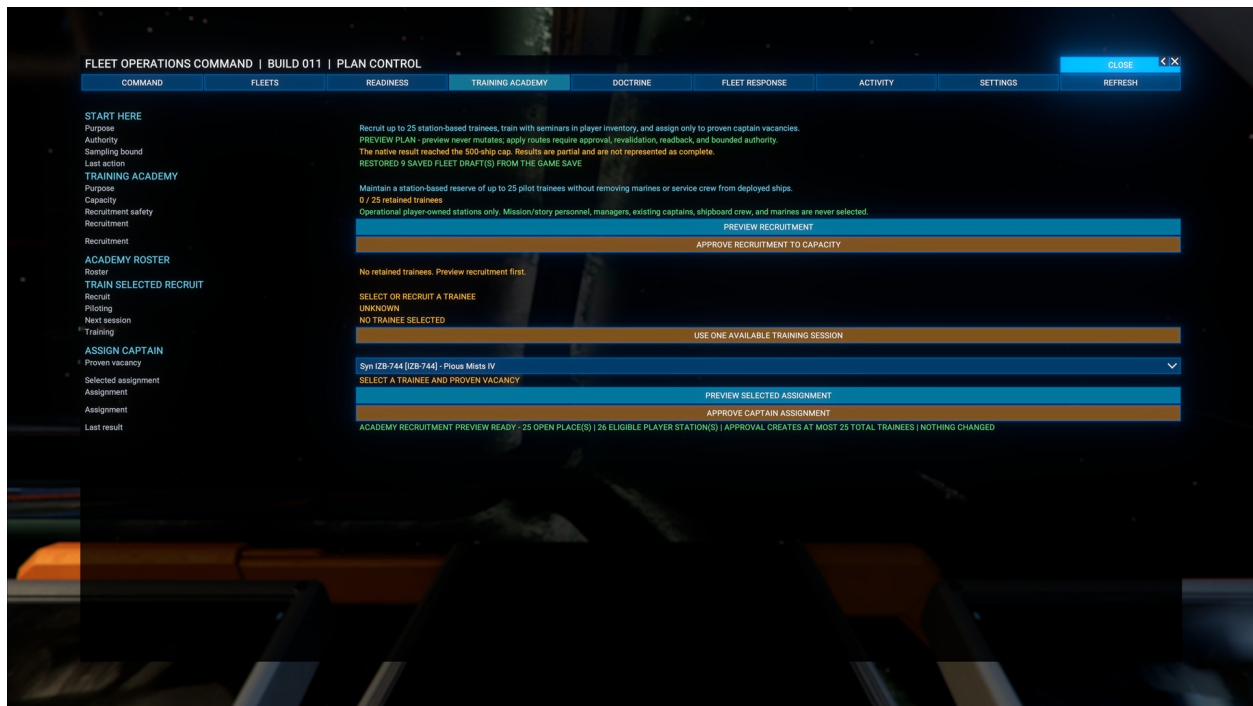
- **MISSING** means FOC proved that the ship can take a pilot and currently has none.
- **UNKNOWN** means the evidence was incomplete. FOC will not use it as permission to move anyone.

What to do

- 1 Read the **SHIPS NEEDING CAPTAINS** list.
- 2 Note the ship name, stable identity code, and location.
- 3 Read unknown evidence separately.
- 4 Select **OPEN TRAINING ACADEMY** when you want to fill a proven vacancy.

A fleet can appear structurally complete but remain unable to act when one required ship has no captain.

9. TRAINING ACADEMY - Pilots, Marines, and captains



Training Academy page

The shared roster

The Academy keeps one station-based reserve of no more than 25 trainees. Every retained trainee may receive Pilot or Marine training and then be assigned under the selected focus.

FOC never takes managers, existing captains, mission/story people, or deployed shipboard crew for recruitment.

Recruit one trainee

- 1 Choose **PILOT** or **MARINE** focus.
- 2 Select **PREVIEW RECRUITMENT**.
- 3 Read the eligible-station and capacity result.
- 4 Select **APPROVE ONE TRAINEE** only when the preview is correct.
- 5 Wait for roster readback.

Train one session

- 1 Choose a trainee.
- 2 Read the current skill, maximum rank, and required supply.
- 3 Select **TRAIN ONE SESSION**.
- 4 Wait for both skill and inventory readback.

One click consumes at most one correct training supply.

Assign a Pilot as captain

- 1 Select **PILOT** focus.

- 2 Choose one trainee and one proven captain vacancy.
- 3 Preview the exact pair.
- 4 Select **TRANSFER PILOT TO CAPTAIN POST**.
- 5 Wait for native assigned-pilot readback.

Assign a Marine

- 1 Select **MARINE** focus.
- 2 Choose one trainee and one eligible destination ship.
- 3 Preview the exact pair.
- 4 Approve the transfer.
- 5 Wait for native Marine role and destination readback.

Captain auto-fill

Preview before approval. FOC revalidates up to 25 proven vacancies, retained Pilot trainees, Academy capacity, eligible player stations, and complete seminar inventory. It recruits only missing trainees, trains selected Pilots to the required level, assigns each to a still-vacant ship, and reports requested, recruited, assigned, and blocked counts.

No existing captain or shipboard crew is taken.

10. ACADEMY STORE - buy training supplies

Open **ACADEMY STORE** when training is blocked by missing supplies.

- 1 Review the current inventory and available purchase.
- 2 Preview the purchase.
- 3 Read the quantity and credit cost.
- 4 Approve only the purchase you understand.
- 5 Wait for credit and inventory readback.
- 6 Return to **TRAINING ACADEMY** and refresh.

The Store is a player-approved spending action. Opening the page, refreshing, or previewing does not spend credits.

11. FLEET RESPONSE - answer one fresh distress call

Fleet Response checks whether one ready fleet may answer a recent attack. It considers ownership, urgency, damage, distance, captain, readiness, player control, story protection, response locks, current orders, and incident age.

What to do

- 1 Start and arm an eligible fleet on **FLEETS**.
- 2 Wait for a real attack on an allowed player ship or station.

- 3 Open **FLEET RESPONSE**.
- 4 Confirm the victim, attacker, selected fleet, and response rules.
- 5 Preview the dispatch.
- 6 Approve one dispatch when eligible.
- 7 Wait for X4's native Attack-order readback.
- 8 Open **ACTIVITY**.

Flood protection

Repeated reports from the same current attacker are grouped into one incident. FOC selects one closest eligible fleet and attempts one uniquely named native Attack order. The incident and responding fleet stay locked until the quiet/recovery rule is satisfied or a required object no longer exists.

Do not keep pressing Approve while an action is pending.

12. ACTIVITY - read the proof trail



Activity page

Activity shows the newest bounded actions and saved session history. It is the first place to look when a button seems to do nothing.

Entries can show:

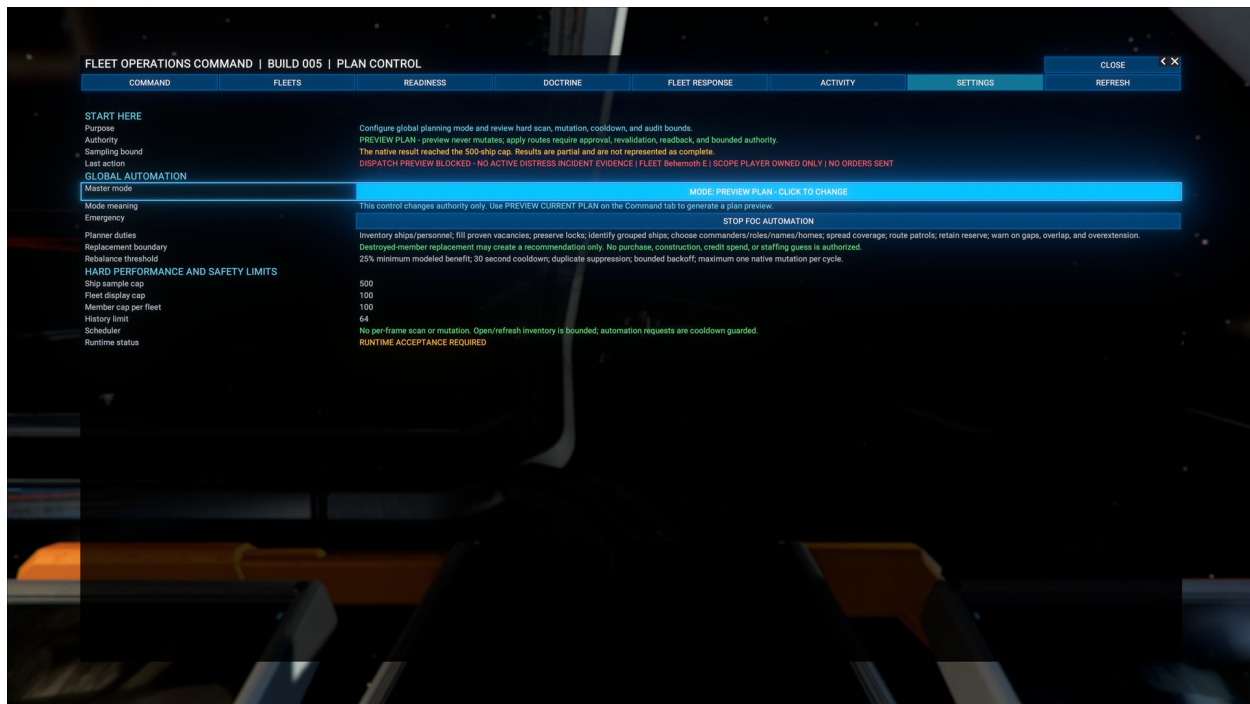
- the request and stable subject;
- whether an attack was detected, grouped, dispatched, resolved, or blocked;
- which fleet was selected and why;

- whether one native order was attempted;
- repair, rebuild, training, Store, and story-protection results; and
- what X4 returned.

Ordinary distress entries are amber. Damage and positively lost-ship rebuild events can be red. Confirmed actions and releases are green.

Read the newest entry literally. Correct only the named problem. If a green result disagrees with the real X4 state, stop and report it as a bug.

13. SETTINGS - decide how much authority FOC has



Settings page

Keep **PREVIEW PLAN** until you have:

- 1 started one fleet from **FLEETS**;
- 2 confirmed its movement in X4;
- 3 seen correct native readback in **ACTIVITY**; and
- 4 tested one manual distress response.

Use **APPLY APPROVED PLAN** when you want Command to apply eligible saved plans. Use **FULL AUTOMATION** only when you want bounded automatic distress dispatch.

Important bounds

- Fleet discovery examines no more than 500 top-level candidates per structural snapshot.
- Up to 100 fleets and 100 members per fleet are displayed.
- Global saved-plan application handles no more than 100 Draft records.

- Academy bulk assignment handles no more than 25 exact pairs per approval.
- Live Activity retains 50 rows and displays the newest 12.
- Full Automation uses one 30-second scheduler and attempts at most one eligible response per cycle.

A visible cap means the result is bounded. It does not mean an unseen object is safe.

14. Advanced Fleet Controls

Select **SHOW ADVANCED CONTROLS** only when you need additional fleet state and manual controls.

Advanced controls can preview current saved state, save without sending, lock or unlock the selected fleet, preserve or replace eligible orders, and expose more readback details.

They do not restore removed custom routes, sector lists, or patrol-pattern controls. Version 1.34 exposes only behavior backed by implemented native X4 orders.

Important: A saved fleet Draft is not proof that a patrol is active. Look for PATROL ACTIVE and confirm the real X4 order.

15. Confirm behavior in X4



Patrol in action

FOC's readback matters, but also check the game world:

- 1 Open the X4 map.
- 2 Select the fleet commander.
- 3 Check current and default behavior.

- 4 Watch the fleet begin moving.
- 5 Confirm escorts remain assigned.
- 6 Check **READINESS** if one escort does not move.
- 7 Check **ACTIVITY** after a distress response, repair handoff, assignment, or rebuild.

Old or removed mods can leave malformed ship or crew state. FOC blocks uncertain state instead of guessing.

16. Troubleshooting

FOC does not appear

- Confirm the extension is enabled.
- Confirm a manual path ends in `extensions/jk_foc/content.xml`.
- Dock, close the interaction menu, and open it again.
- Check whether another UI mod replaces the docked interaction menu.

A fleet is missing

- Confirm it is a player-owned top-level combat commander.
- Confirm it has at least one living combat subordinate.
- Station guards and station-commanded ships are excluded.
- Cargo, mining, trade, and other non-combat commanders are excluded from the combat list.
- Check both fleet-list pages.

My fleet will not start

- Does the commander have a captain?
- Does the fleet have a Home point?
- Are you personally controlling the commander?
- Is one member still protected by a story or mission?
- Is there a critical order that cannot be cancelled safely?
- Read the exact blocker above the Send button.

FOC says a finished story ship is protected

Read the exact ship name and question. Choose **NO - LET FOC CONTROL IT** only when you know that ship is no longer being used by a story or mission. Your answer changes FOC only.

A repair or rebuild is unavailable

- Refresh native readback.
- Confirm the ship is eligible and not protected.
- For repairs, let X4 calculate the real price and resources.

- For rebuilds, confirm the exact blueprint is owned.
- Confirm a compatible player-owned yard can build the saved hull and loadout.
- Confirm no living ship or duplicate build already represents that loss.

An action stays pending

Do not click repeatedly. Wait, refresh once, and inspect **ACTIVITY**. If no result appears, preserve a screenshot and the relevant X4 debug log.

The result and the game disagree

Treat that as a bug. Record the fleet, ship, button, visible FOC result, real X4 state, approximate time, and any older mod that changed the object.

Report issues at github.com/razoreqx1/FOC/issues.

17. Quick command card

Start one patrol

FLEETS -> select fleet -> answer any story question -> choose Home -> set response rules -> SEND THIS FLEET ON PATROL -> wait for PATROL ACTIVE -> ACTIVITY

Fill one captain vacancy

READINESS -> TRAINING ACADEMY -> PILOT -> choose trainee and vacancy -> PREVIEW -> TRANSFER PILOT TO CAPTAIN POST -> REFRESH

Assign a Marine

TRAINING ACADEMY -> MARINE -> choose trainee and ship -> PREVIEW -> APPROVE TRANSFER -> ACTIVITY

Repair a damaged fleet ship

FLEETS -> REPAIR / REPLACE / REBUILD -> select damaged ship -> native Repair / Upgrade -> review X4 cost -> confirm in X4

Review or rebuild a lost ship

FLEETS -> REPAIR / REPLACE / REBUILD -> refresh -> review exact lost record -> PREVIEW -> approve eligible rebuild -> refresh for readback

Answer one distress call

FLEETS -> arm eligible fleet -> fresh attack -> FLEET RESPONSE -> PREVIEW -> APPROVE ONE DISPATCH -> ACTIVITY

Stop automation

COMMAND or SETTINGS -> STOP FOC AUTOMATION -> wait for confirmation -> ACTIVITY

18. Getting help

Before reporting a problem, take a screenshot of the complete FOC page and write down what the affected ship is actually doing in X4. Include the visible result, fleet name, ship name, action, approximate time, and whether another mod changed that ship.

- Steam Workshop: <https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=3793624775>
- Project and issues: <https://github.com/razoreqx1/FOC>

FOC watches. You command.